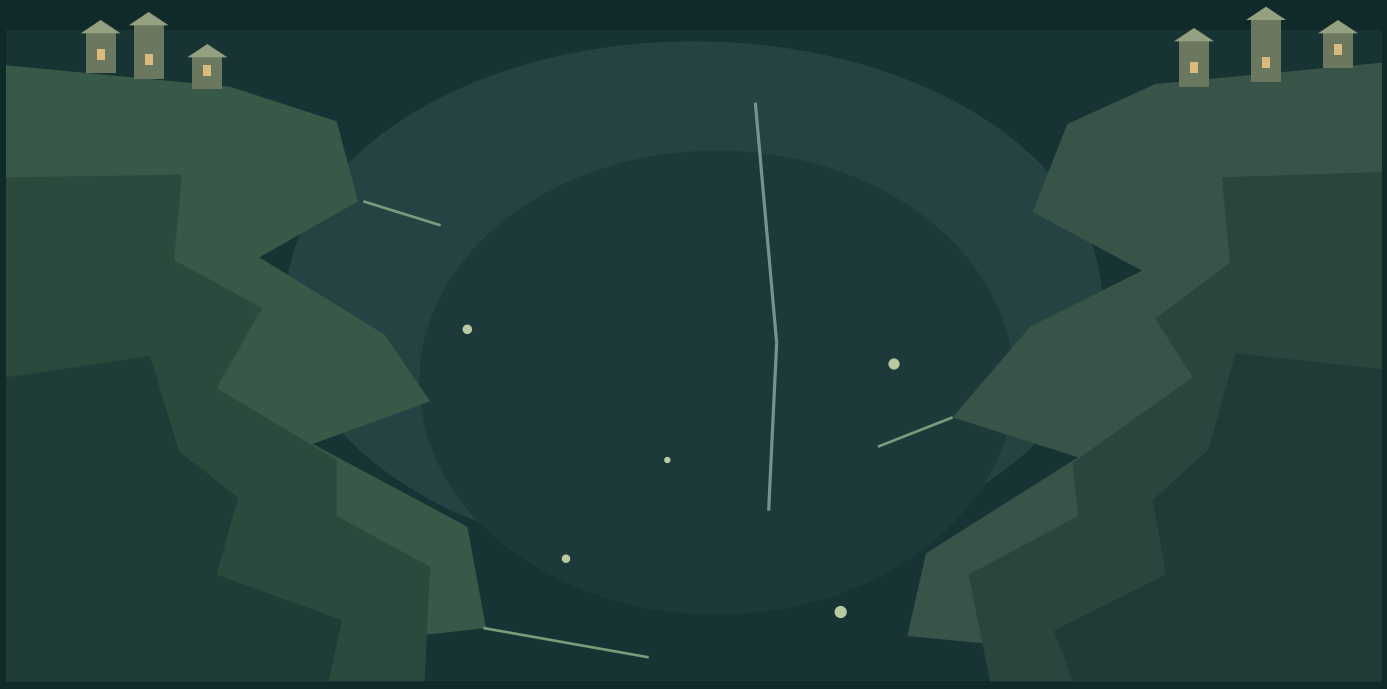
Hollowbound

Descend. Discover. Return.

A social exploration game about venturing into a beautiful, dangerous chasm, finding extraordinary relics, and surviving the journey home.



ORIGINAL ATMOSPHERE STUDY / PROPOSED VISUAL DIRECTION

Prepared for Carlos Abreu

Version 0.2 / October 11, 2026

Current decisions, delegated recommendations, and open details from the design discussion. The working title remains provisional. Implementation planning belongs to a later discussion.

02 / INTENT & READING GUIDE

The game at a glance

Hollowbound is a Roblox exploration and extraction game set around a vast, beautiful, dangerous chasm. Players prepare in town, descend for materials and relics, survive creatures and terrain, then bring discoveries home. Relics improve what an explorer can do and become valuable possessions to use, sell, trade, or display.

Decided - The experience being designed

- **Exploration leads:** hidden routes, ruins, creatures, useful materials, and surprising discoveries are the main attraction.
- **Relics define capability:** exceptional equipment, knowledge of the depths, preparation, and crew coordination distinguish a strong explorer.
- **Player encounters add uncertainty:** cooperation and theft are possible; PvP remains a secondary feature.
- **Progress lasts:** ranks and secured relic collections give players reasons to return and attempt harder expeditions.

How to read this record

Status	Meaning
Decided	An explicit user choice or stated design wish.
Delegated	The user asked the assistant to choose; the resulting recommendation is recorded as the working direction.
Proposed	An assistant suggestion or illustrative example that has not been selected.
Open	A preference, exact rule, or balance value that still needs a decision or testing.

Inside the document

3-4: world, navigation, expeditions, and survival. **5-7:** relics, appraisal, ownership, and loss. **8-9:** combat, solo play, crews, theft, and camps. **10-11:** ranks, materials, shops, and trading. **12-13:** rare hunts, refreshes, tutorial, lore, and endgame. **14-16:** example relics, an expedition scenario, revisions, and open details.

Creative references named in the discussion: Made in Abyss for layered wilderness, relics, mystery, and ascent danger; ARC Raiders for preparation, looting, encounters, and extraction; Steal an Egg for visible collecting, progression, and social interaction. Original locations, lore, creatures, and artifacts are the intended direction.

03 / DEPTHS, ROUTES & DISCOVERY

The world & navigation

Decided - A hybrid world

The upper depths form a continuous explorable world. Exceptional deep regions are entered as separate expeditions. Each exceptional expedition can contain several independent explorers or crews, allowing encounters throughout the trip.

Geography changes substantially between expeditions, especially in deeper regions. Learning a depth means understanding its environment, hazards, creatures, and possible routes as well as recognizing useful landmarks.

Decided - Maps that grow with exploration

An unfamiliar expedition begins with an incomplete map. Terrain fills in as the player explores. Players can place markers and share crew pings to coordinate routes, discoveries, danger, and rendezvous points.

Proposed - Layout and information rules

- Generate one shared layout for an expedition and keep it stable while that expedition is underway.
- Keep useful anchors such as camps, major ruins, and landmarks recognizable while routes and local opportunities vary.
- Show explored terrain, camps, landmarks, and crew information on the map. Discover strangers through sight, sound, tracks, or appropriate relic abilities.
- Provide several approaches to valuable sites and several ways back toward safety.

Delegated - Access to the depths

Ordinary depths remain open, with a recommended rank and increasingly demanding survival conditions. Exceptional expeditions require an appropriate explorer rank. Experience, supplies, and relics make dangerous regions more manageable; the environment creates the difficulty.

Proposed - Atmosphere by region

Region	Visual direction
Upper depths	Mist, sunlight, hanging gardens, cliffside forests, and waterfalls.
Middle depths	Luminous plants, enormous nests, flooded ruins, and abandoned settlements.
Deep regions	Dark water, unfamiliar architecture, ancient machinery, and distant creature lights.

04 / TRAVEL, SUPPLIES & ASCENT

An expedition worth repeating

Prepare in town. Descend and discover. Decide when to turn back. Survive the ascent. Bring the haul home.

Decided - Purpose and duration

Expeditions combine material gathering, relic hunting, hidden routes, mysteries, and creature encounters. Other explorers add uncertainty. Exploration, relic use, creature combat, and memorable discoveries remain the main premise.

There is no expedition time limit. Length varies with depth and the player's goal. Equipment condition, remaining food, strain, and danger make turning back a meaningful decision. Trips should stay engaging rather than becoming compulsory long journeys.

Decided - Survival priorities

Pressure	Role in the expedition
Equipment	Manage tools, weapon readiness, healing supplies, ammunition, and relic charges or fuel.
Food	Prepare enough provisions to explore and return. Water and injury treatment also belong in the survival system.
Ascent strain	Climbing from lower depths requires more recovery and resting. Some relics reveal or provide routes with less strain.
Fatigue and injuries	Camps offer opportunities to rest and treat problems during a trip. Exact effects remain open.

Decided - Carrying discoveries

Ordinary items go into inventory. Exceptional discoveries are carried visibly, giving nearby players a way to notice a remarkable find. Carrying a valuable item creates a practical challenge during the return journey.

Decided - A camp is a refuge

New loot stays in the backpack when a player reaches a camp. It remains at risk after leaving. Only returning to town secures a newly recovered relic.

Proposed - Rest and route choices

Use camps for rest, treatment, and planning. Provide sheltered climbs, shortcuts, and relic-assisted passages with clear strain warnings. Symptoms, recovery rates, cargo effects, and costs remain open.

05 / THE CENTRAL REWARD

Relics: types, traits & power

Decided - Useful, valuable possessions

Relics are expensive discoveries that give practical advantages during exploration, combat, survival, or extraction. Players can use them, sell them, trade them, and build collections. Deeper relics mainly add new abilities and possibilities; earlier relics continue to have useful roles.

Decided - Every specimen has an identity

Copies of the same relic can differ substantially in strength, traits, and drawbacks. A particularly good specimen can accomplish things that a weaker specimen of the same type cannot. Better specimens are rarer and more likely to be found farther down.

Traits are permanent. Players can repair and recharge a specimen. They cannot upgrade, reroll, or replace its inherent traits through the current design.

Working interpretation - Two sources of rarity

Rarity comes from both the relic type and the quality of the individual specimen. A scarce type can be exciting to discover; an extraordinary specimen of that type can become a much more valuable find. The exact rating system and rarity names are open.

Proposed example - Same relic, different capability

Windhook specimen	Illustrative differences
Ordinary	Shorter reach, modest cargo support, and greater charge use.
Unusually strong	Longer reach, better carrying strength, and more efficient use.
Exceptional	A rare combination of reach, stability, and efficiency that opens routes other specimens cannot manage.

Decided - One exceptional relic plus support

An expedition loadout can include one highest-rarity exceptional relic and a small number of weaker support relics. The exact number of support slots remains open.

Proposed - Applying that limit fairly

Classify an equipped relic using the actual specimen's rarity and power. An extraordinarily strong version of a normally common type would count toward the exceptional slot when appropriate. Equip and swap rules should preserve the intended loadout limit.

06 / ACQUISITION, ACTIVATION & APPRAISAL

Finding & understanding relics

Decided - Relics throughout the depths

Every depth contains relics. Each type has a usual or assigned depth, with stronger discoveries generally coming from deeper exploration. A very rare relic has a very low chance of appearing outside its assigned depth, including a shallower region. Lucky discoveries remain part of the appeal.

Acquisition route	What players experience
Exploration	Find relics in hidden places, ruins, or other discoveries.
Creature dens	Reach a den and defeat a creature guarding its treasure.
Events and dedicated challenges	Complete a demanding encounter or objective for a valuable relic opportunity.
Player exchange	Receive a relic through a voluntary gift, sale, or trade.
Town shops	Buy common support relics. Valuable rare specimens remain expedition and player-market discoveries.

Decided - Activation varies by relic

Some freshly found relics work immediately during the expedition. Unfamiliar or powerful relics may require activation. Some activation uses town services and materials; other activation requires discoveries or challenges in the depths.

Delegated - Identification with a second moment of discovery

Show a relic's type, rarity, and unsecured status immediately on pickup. Reveal its exact strengths, traits, and drawbacks through a field appraisal kit or free appraisal in town. Purchased shop relics arrive already appraised. Once identified, the traits remain visible, including during trades.

Appraisal reveals properties. Activation enables use. Registration in town provides lasting protection.

These are separate states. Appraising or activating a newly found relic during a trip does not secure it against theft or expedition death.

Open details

The appraisal tool's operation, activation recipes, challenge requirements, rarity tiers, trait pools, and exact spawning chances still need specification. No universal mastery trial has been selected.

07 / WHAT IS ACTUALLY AT STAKE

Ownership, defeat & loss

Decided - Pickup establishes the claim

Whoever picks an item up owns it and can voluntarily give or trade it. Crews do not automatically pool their haul. A newly found relic remains unsecured until it reaches town; ownership does not provide protection during extraction.

Decided - A chance to recover before death

A defeated player enters a brief downed state. Another player can revive them, or they can use a limited self-rescue item. The exact window, costs, interruption rules, and health restored remain open.

Decided - Final expedition death

Carried possession	Outcome after final death
Weapons, armour, ordinary tools, supplies, and gathered materials	Drop as loot that other players can recover.
Fresh, unregistered relics	Drop and can change hands. A new carrier must bring them home.
Previously registered relics	Return safely to their owner, but require repair or recharging before reuse.
Items left in town	Remain outside the carried expedition haul.

Decided - Protection belongs specifically to relics

Registered relics are the only protected category of equipment carried into an expedition. Ordinary weapons, armour, materials, and supplies remain lootable. Relic protection lets players use valuable discoveries repeatedly while failed trips still cost ordinary gear, fresh loot, and recovery resources.

Working interpretation - Keep the lasting specimen intact

Repair and recharging restore usability while preserving the specimen's traits. Voluntary sales or trades transfer ownership. Recovery should preserve one specimen and its current owner.

Proposed - Getting back into exploration

The user was comfortable with either a free basic kit or an inexpensive purchased replacement. The recommended combination is a free basic kit with inexpensive better replacement kits. Exact contents, eligibility, and prices are open.

Body-loot access, finishing a downed player, disconnects, dropped-cargo recovery, and the detailed repair economy still require rules.

08 / CAPABILITY THROUGH PREPARATION

Combat, creatures & solo play

Decided - A broad combat toolkit

Combat includes melee weapons, ranged weapons, and relic abilities. Dodging, parrying, aiming, and timing matter. The primary signs of a strong player are the relics they possess, experience throughout the depths, intelligent preparation, and effective crew coordination.

Terrain, stealth, traps, escape routes, ability combinations, and knowledge of creature behaviour should give players several ways to handle a dangerous situation. The user specifically wants success to depend less heavily on precise parry timing and internet quality than the Deepwoken-style experience they described.

Decided - Most creatures can be defeated

Most dangerous creatures are killable. A few overwhelming creatures must be evaded or outsmarted. Even a well-equipped veteran has reasons to read the environment, recognize danger, and choose another route.

Proposed - Readable threats and useful knowledge

- Give threatening creatures signs such as tracks, sounds, disturbed vegetation, territorial behaviour, or den evidence.
- Make different senses and behaviours matter: a sound-sensitive creature rewards silence; a territorial guardian rewards understanding its patrols.
- Let positioning, preparation, and relic use influence the encounter alongside weapon execution.
- Offer viable hiding, escape, distraction, and route choices around overwhelming threats.

Decided - The hardest relic hunts remain solo-achievable

Excellent preparation, experience, and suitable relics should let a solo explorer complete every required hunt objective. A crew can help, but is never mandatory for the hardest relic hunts. Required objectives need a viable solo method.

Proposed - Crews add options; solo explorers need agency

Support solo play with stealth, traversal, controlled engagement, and escape tools. Crews gain flexibility through different loadouts and roles. Group visibility, noise, creature responses, and limits on overlapping support effects can help balance those advantages.

These are balance goals, not tested guarantees of equal combat odds. Enemy statistics, targeting, solo routes, and group effects remain open.

09 / TRUST, THEFT & REFUGE

Crews, strangers & safe camps

Decided - Trusted crews of up to four

The largest organised expedition crew has four players. Crewmates are protected from one another's attacks and sabotage. Crew pings support coordination. Pickup ownership still applies, with gifts and trades remaining voluntary.

Decided - Occasional, meaningful encounters

Explorers encounter strangers occasionally, with enough room to avoid or approach them. A stranger can become a trading partner, temporary ally, rival, or threat. PvP is an available way to steal loot, while creatures and discovery remain central.

Decided - Selected forms of theft

- Use traps or sabotage to make a carrier drop cargo.
- Recover abandoned loot after creatures defeat its owner.
- Defeat a carrier and take dropped, unprotected items.

Decided - Visible safe zones throughout the map

Camps provide clear refuge during the expedition. Recent aggressors wait briefly before gaining camp protection; defenders can seek safety immediately. Exact aggression detection and protection timers remain open. Loot stays carried and unsecured until town.

Proposed - Preventing predictable ambushes

- Provide several camp entrances, covered approaches, and alternative return routes.
- Make safe boundaries readable and prevent attacks or traps from exploiting those boundaries.
- Use roaming hazards and supply costs to make prolonged interception positions demanding.
- Keep protection briefly after leaving or being removed from a crew, reducing opportunities for kick-then-attack betrayal.
- Show an aggression indicator and protection countdown; defensive retaliation should preserve the defender's access to refuge.

A valuable fresh relic can still change hands late in an expedition. The new carrier inherits the remaining extraction problem. Repeated town-exit ambushes should not become the dominant way to acquire relics.

10 / A PROGRESSION WORTH PURSUING

Ranks, rewards & lasting XP

Decided - Automatic promotion through earned experience

Ranks advance through XP earned from exploration and discoveries, defeating creatures, and recovering valuable relics. Players who explore more, overcome more creatures, and bring home rarer relics should advance accordingly. Promotion does not require a qualification trial.

Decided - What survives a failed expedition

Progress	When it is kept
Discovery XP	Retained even if the expedition ends in death.
Creature-combat XP	Retained even if the expedition ends in death.
Valuable relic recovery XP	Requires bringing the newly recovered relic home to town.

Decided - Every rank should reward the player

Reward family	Desired benefits
Crafting and town services	Better crafting, repair and recharging services, and preparation options.
Exploration opportunities	Special contracts, events, and exceptional expeditions.
Explorer improvements	Stamina, recovery, or carrying-capacity improvements.
Visible prestige	Exclusive insignias, outfits, titles, and lodge features.

Proposed - Meaningful contribution and discovery credit

Award creature XP for meaningful contributions, including supporting teammates. Credit assistance in exploration and recovery while item ownership stays with the carrier. Award new-discovery credit in a way that preserves the value of genuine exploration and recovery.

Proposed - Names and presentation

An earlier example ladder used Copper, Iron, Silver, Gold, Obsidian, and Astral, with lantern insignias. Names, rank count, XP thresholds, reward amounts, and ceremonies remain provisional.

Ordinary-depth recommended ranks and exceptional-expedition required ranks are the current recommended access model. Rank supports capability and prestige; a valuable relic acquired through trading does not itself establish exploration history.

11 / THE PLAYER ECONOMY & SOCIAL INTERFACE

Materials, shops & trading

Working direction - Preparation creates useful resources

Ordinary gear and materials support expeditions even though they are expendable after death. Equipment, food, healing, ammunition, crafting inputs, and relic repair or recharge resources give explorers reasons to gather, buy, and sell. Exact recipes and material names are open.

Decided - Town shops sell common support relics

NPC shops sell ordinary equipment and supplies plus common support relics. Rare specimens are pursued through exploration, difficult opportunities, and player exchanges. Their usefulness and scarcity make keeping, selling, or trading a find a meaningful choice.

Decided - A trade board followed by a meeting

Players post what they are offering and what they want, then meet to agree on a trade. Offers can involve money, materials, or other relics. The town market becomes a place to inspect discoveries, negotiate, and meet explorers with complementary equipment.

Proposed - A clear trade flow

Step	Interface behaviour
Post an offer	Display the specimen, desired exchange, seller, and a way to arrange a meeting.
Inspect	Show identified traits, rarity, activation status, condition, and remaining charge.
Negotiate	Each player chooses the final items and money in their side of the exchange.
Confirm	Both players confirm the final terms. Changes require confirmation again.
Complete	Transfer each specimen and its ownership to the agreed recipient.

Proposed - Other ways the interface can bring players together

Expedition recruitment posts, contextual Invite and Trade actions, rescue requests, collection inspections, and assistance with visible cargo can complement the trade board. The earlier guild-board mockup illustrated recruitment, rescues, and trades with sample players; it was a concept demonstration.

Currency names, NPC resale prices, crafting costs, fees, trader protections, rescue rewards, and any lodge income remain open. Mandatory equal crew shares are not part of the selected pickup-ownership rule.

12 / EARNED OPPORTUNITY & DEVELOPER CONTROL

Rare hunts & a changing world

Decided goal - Rare but attainable

Exceptional relics should be scarce, highly valuable, and useful enough to change expedition possibilities. Skilled explorers can find them through demanding play; a capable thief can take an unsecured find. Extremely lucky discoveries in shallower regions also remain possible.

Delegated - Visible progress toward better opportunities

Difficult discoveries and contracts earn research progress toward a relic type. Accumulated clues reveal promising ruins, dens, or special opportunities in shared expeditions. These hunts improve the odds of exceptional specimens. The final specimen's quality remains random, and the player must extract it.

The journal can show research progress and the next lead. Stronger combinations remain especially rare, with deeper challenges providing the best chances. This gives dedicated players direction alongside spontaneous discovery. Required challenges remain solo-achievable.

Delegated - Permanent expeditions and recurring events

Maintain a permanent catalogue of exceptional expeditions, plus temporary events that return periodically. Permanent hunts let players revisit a region and pursue particular relics. Events introduce unusual creatures, opened ruins, and distinctive specimens. Valuable event rewards become obtainable again when an event returns.

Closing an event stops new entries. Explorers already inside can finish their trip normally, preserving the no-time-limit expedition rule.

Working design - The developer defines the spawning rules

Control	What it determines
Where and what	Eligible relic types, usual depths, valid sites, creature dens, and event rewards.
Rarity and quality	Relative spawn weights, specimen quality, traits, and tiny off-depth chances.
Availability	Refresh rules, encounter conditions, event openings, and active opportunity limits.
Server variation	Which local discoveries and encounters appear under the same overall rules.

Daily conditions or contract refreshes are possible recommendations. A daily world refresh does not erase ranks or secured relics. No daily reset requirement, exact timer, global supply cap, or server-hopping rule has been selected.

13 / TUTORIAL, MYSTERY & COLLECTION

First discoveries to veteran goals

Decided - A short solo tutorial, then the shared world

A new player begins with a short solo tutorial expedition and then enters the normal shared upper depths. The tutorial introduces the expedition loop before strangers and crews become part of it.

Proposed - Teach a complete trip

Prepare basic supplies, explore a route, encounter a creature, discover a common relic, manage the ascent, and register the find in town. Introduce unsecured versus protected relics clearly. Exact tutorial content and duration remain open.

Decided - The veteran loop

The main long-term appeal is finding rarer and better relic specimens and exploring new expeditions when they release. Different players can also pursue deeper mysteries, difficult challenges, exploration records, crew achievements, impressive lodges, and cosmetic collections.

Personal pursuit	What success can look like
Relic collection	Own a remarkable specimen, complete a collection, or assemble a distinctive loadout.
Exploration and mysteries	Master difficult expeditions and reveal secrets of the depths.
Prestige and crew feats	Earn records, titles, and recognition for notable accomplishments.
Lodges and appearance	Display discoveries, outfits, trophies, and personal style.

Delegated - Exploration-led storytelling

Use environmental clues, ruins, machines, creature behaviour, and relic origins to reveal history. Short town NPC conversations and a persistent field journal provide context, practical information, activation clues, and ongoing mysteries. Major discoveries in exceptional expeditions can advance the larger story.

Open - A home for the collection

Lodges and displays are desired long-term features. Customization has not been chosen: a furnished premade lodge, expandable rooms, or a largely player-built home remain possible. Visitors, crafting facilities, and research income are earlier proposals, not locked rules.

14 / IDEAS RETAINED FOR LATER DESIGN

Illustrative relic catalogue

The names, abilities, costs, and challenges below are assistant examples from the discussion. They are not a finalized item roster, rarity assignment, or balance table. A type can have different permanent specimen traits.

Relic idea	Possible expedition use	Possible limit or drawback
Echo Lens	Reveal concealed entrances, buried chambers, and hidden passages.	Limited scan range; crystal fuel.
Anchor Charm	Reduce the wearer's ascent strain.	Magnitude, cost, and recharge rules remain open.
Anchor Heart	Reduce ascent strain for nearby crewmates during activation.	The wielder moves more slowly; group stacking needs limits.
Windhook	Reach ledges or anchor points and support different traversal routes.	Suitable anchors, reach limits, charges, or cooldowns.
Wayfarer Key	Restore dormant lifts or activate ancient shortcuts.	Activation attracts creatures or demands other preparation.
Stillbell	Suppress movement sounds to aid stealth or escape.	Attacks break the effect; some creatures use other senses.
Pathfinder's Eye	Identify passages where the ascent causes less strain.	Access depends on the surrounding terrain; other costs remain open.

Proposed - Challenges linked to the relic

- Reach an aerial guardian through climbing routes for a traversal relic.
- Survive a chamber with shifting ascent conditions for a strain-management relic.
- Investigate misleading sounds and concealed tunnels for a discovery relic.
- Restore machinery while managing creatures for an ancient-lift relic.

Any required objective needs a viable solo solution. Specimen traits should create meaningful differences in reach, strength, efficiency, utility, or drawbacks. Older relic types should retain useful situations.

Moonseed was an illustrative collectible. Glowglass lens and Storm fern appeared in the sample trade interface; their abilities were not defined. Creature companions and egg hatching were early optional ideas, not part of the selected core loop.

15 / AN ILLUSTRATION OF THE CURRENT RULES

One possible expedition

This scenario is an example assembled from the design decisions. Its route, creature, relic specimen, and events are illustrative rather than additional locked content.

1. Prepare and choose a goal

A solo explorer leaves town with ordinary weapons, food, treatment supplies, a self-rescue item, and a registered support relic. The support relic is protected if they die, but the rest of the carried kit is at risk. They follow a research lead toward a promising creature den.

2. Read an unfamiliar route

The current expedition has different routes from their last visit. The map fills as they move. Tracks and distant calls warn of an overwhelming creature. Knowledge of its behaviour and a quiet side passage let the explorer continue safely.

3. Earn the discovery

A killable guardian protects the den. The explorer combines terrain, weapon use, and a relic ability to overcome it. They discover an unusually good specimen: its type and rarity are immediately visible. Field appraisal reveals its exact permanent traits. Any activation requirement remains separate.

4. Choose the return route

The explorer decides the haul is worth bringing home. Equipment is worn and food is running low. They rest at a camp, but the new relic stays unsecured. Another crew passes nearby; both sides have room to avoid an encounter. A lower-strain passage offers a useful return option.

5. The final stretch has consequences

If a rival attacks, the defender can seek camp refuge immediately while the aggressor must wait for protection. If the explorer is downed, another player or the limited self-rescue item can help. Final death drops ordinary gear and the fresh relic; their registered support relic returns needing service.

6. Bring the prize home

Reaching town secures the new relic and earns its recovery XP. Discovery and creature-combat XP would have survived a failed trip. The explorer can register and use the specimen, display it, sell it, or post a trade offer. Its traits stay fixed throughout its ownership history.

The valuable moment is both finding the specimen and completing the journey that makes it yours to keep.

16 / WHAT IS SETTLED AND WHAT REMAINS

Open details & revision record

The central concept and major systems are established; exact values and detailed rules remain open. This record covers the design through October 11, 2026. Implementation planning belongs to the next discussion.

Open - Remaining design and balance choices

Area	Details still to specify
World	Depth names and sizes, landmarks, generated-layout rules, camp placement, and server population.
Relics	Final catalogue, rarity labels, trait pools, quality ratings, support slots, equipping rules, activation, and appraisal tools.
Survival and combat	Strain symptoms, food and treatment rules, movement, weapon details, creature behaviour, and solo/group balance.
Defeat and protection	Downed windows, self-rescue costs, corpse access, disconnects, aggression detection, camp boundaries, and recovery costs.
Progression and economy	Rank names and thresholds, reward amounts, currencies, prices, recipes, replacement kits, and contribution-credit rules.
Rare opportunities	Drop odds, quality weights, research milestones, clue persistence, encounter limits, refresh cadence, and event schedules.
Town and presentation	Lodge customization, collection displays, record categories, cosmetics, overall art treatment, target devices, and monetization.

Important changes since version 0.1

- **Town secures relics:** depth camps offer refuge; registration happens in town.
- **Relic protection:** registered relics return needing service; all other carried loot can drop.
- **XP promotes ranks:** the earlier promotion-trial idea has been superseded.
- **Pickup establishes ownership:** mandatory equal crew shares were not selected.
- **Quality stays fixed:** specimens differ substantially; repair and recharge preserve their traits.
- **Solo access:** every required relic hunt is solo-achievable; crews have up to four.

Earlier mastery trials, guaranteed sanctuary rewards, fixed two-relic loadouts, and timer examples remain unselected proposals. Delegated recommendations are labelled throughout this record.

Record notes: Prepared from Carlos Abreu's design discussion. Hollowbound is the working title, including the message calling it "hollow point". No mechanics have been implemented or playtested.